procession also came to my village. We welcomed them and cooked food for the RSS members. But they refused to have food at our house. A senior leader consoled me by putting his hand on my shoulder, saying, ‘Brother, you are a patriot volunteer … You know that the Hindu society is still rigid. We can eat food together from the same plate, but the saints will not be able to eat, so please pack the food. I will give it to them in the next village.’ This statement shocked me, as I used to constantly tell my family that there was no casteism in our sangh, that all Hindus were brothers and considered equal, that there was no discrimination against anyone there. But now this was happening to me. The leaders of my own organization were refusing to eat at my place, a Dalit worker. Finally we packed food for them, which they did not eat but threw on the roadside. Instead, they ate at a pandit’s house late at night.

This news came to me the next morning. For me to know this was as terrible as death. I could not believe it. I visited the place, and upon seeing it with my own eyes couldn’t help but believe it. I realized that those I had journeyed to Ayodhya for and was prepared to make any sacrifice for were not willing to accept the food I had lovingly prepared at home. This made me question my place in the Hindu Rashtra, to which I had been dedicating myself day and night, aspiring to become a full-time pracharak. I was so broken by this incident that I attempted suicide, but I was saved. Then I left this hypocritical and casteist organization and started exposing their mentality. My struggle continues even today.

Rahul ji listened to my experience of joining the RSS and the story of my disillusionment with sensitivity and seriousness. He embraced me with great compassion and love. Rahul ji said, ‘These people have a culture of indulgence—they want dominance over everything. They consider everyone less than themselves. They suffer from a superiority complex. They teach hatred. I came out to give love to people and receive love from them.’ He went on to narrate the mythological story of Mahadev Shiva and Vishnu.

After this, our conversation focused on caste and caste census. Rahul ji talked about why a caste census was necessary. While walking, which was